The Omaha Platform

People's (Populist) Party · July 4, 1892

Source: Omaha Platform (1892). Public domain. Continuous passage.

> The founding platform of the Populist Party gave voice to angry farmers and workers, demanding free silver, a graduated income tax, government ownership of railroads, and direct election of senators — ideas later absorbed into Progressive reform.

The fruits of the toil of millions are boldly stolen to build up colossal fortunes for a few, unprecedented in the history of mankind; and the possessors of those, in turn, despise the republic and endanger liberty. From the same prolific womb of governmental injustice we breed the two great classes — tramps and millionaires.

[. . .]

Second. — Wealth belongs to him who creates it, and every dollar taken from industry without an equivalent is robbery. . . . FINANCE. We demand free and unlimited coinage of silver and gold at the present legal ratio of 16 to 1. . . . We demand a graduated income tax. . . . TRANSPORTATION. Transportation being a means of exchange and a public necessity, the government should own and operate the railroads in the interest of the people.